

GOVERNMENT HACK™

Unit Assessment Book

Unit 4 — The Executive Branch · Teacher Edition

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Three parts: (1) Formative Checkpoints — a short check per standard for progress monitoring (MTSS); (2) Unit Summative — two parallel forms (A and B) for pre/post or retakes; (3) Teacher Answer Key + Item Analysis + Reteach.

All items are pulled from the Government Hack question bank. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Administering these forms is what generates the response data to CALIBRATE the pre-calibrated items — the first cycle of use closes the loop.

Keys and reteach live in this teacher book only — reproduce the student sections (formative + Form A/B) without the key section.

Contents

Part 1 — Formative Checkpoints (by standard)

A quick DOK-balanced check for each standard. Use for progress monitoring; reteach routing is in the Teacher Key.

GC.16 — Article II & the Presidency

1. The President can make treaties and appoint officials only 'by and with the Advice and Consent of the Senate.' What does this requirement create? [GC.16 ·

DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. a power the President may use only in wartime
- B. a rule that the Supreme Court must approve treaties
- C. a legislative check on executive power
- D. a duty for the House to sign each appointment

GC.17 — Departments of the Executive Branch

1. Which executive department is chiefly responsible for foreign policy and diplomacy? [GC.17 · DOK 1 · pre-field-test]

- A. the Department of the Treasury
- B. the Department of State
- C. the Department of Defense
- D. the Department of Justice

GC.18 — The Electoral College

1. How can a candidate win the most votes nationwide yet still lose the presidency? [GC.18 · DOK 3 · pre-field-test]

- A. Most states give all their electoral votes winner-take-all, so the totals can differ
- B. The Supreme Court picks the President in each election
- C. Congress disregards the popular vote entirely
- D. The Cabinet casts the deciding presidential votes

Part 2 — Unit Summative · Form A

DIRECTIONS

Choose the best answer for each question. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

1. Which of the following is a power the Constitution grants to the President in Article II? [GC.16 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. declaring war on another nation
- B. confirming the President's own appointments
- C. writing and passing federal statutes
- D. serving as Commander-in-Chief of the armed forces

2. A counterfeit-money case, a foreign treaty, and a civil-rights complaint each fall to a different department. Which department is chiefly responsible for enforcing federal law? [GC.17 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. the Department of Justice
- B. the Department of State
- C. the Department of the Treasury
- D. the Department of Education

3. Which statement best represents an argument in favor of keeping the Electoral College? [GC.18 · DOK 3 · pre-field-test]

- A. It guarantees the national popular-vote winner always takes office
- B. It removes the states from the presidential election entirely
- C. It protects smaller states and pushes candidates to campaign nationally
- D. It lets Congress choose the President in every election

Part 3 — Unit Summative · Form B

DIRECTIONS

Choose the best answer for each question. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

1. The 22nd Amendment limits an elected President to a maximum of: [GC.16 · DOK 1 · pre-field-test]

- A. one term
- B. two terms
- C. three terms
- D. an unlimited number of terms

2. Analysts use the term 'iron triangle' to describe close ties among which three players in policymaking? [GC.17 · DOK 3 · pre-field-test]

- A. the President, the courts, and the state governors
- B. the House, the Senate, and the President
- C. voters, the political parties, and the news media
- D. an agency, a congressional committee, and interest groups

3. How is each state's number of Electoral College electors determined? [GC.18 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. by adding the state's number of senators and representatives
- B. by the size of the state's land area
- C. by giving an equal number to every state
- D. by the number of counties in the state

Part 4 — Teacher Answer Key + Item Analysis + Reteach

READING THE ANALYSIS

Each item shows its standard, DOK, correct key, and TCAP reporting category, plus a reteach move. Distractor-based routing: a wrong choice signals which idea to reteach — pair with the workbook Cornell notes and Guided Support. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Form A — key & reteach

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
1	GC.16	2	D	RC-GOV4: The Executive Branch	Revisit Article II & the Presidency — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
2	GC.17	2	A	RC-GOV4: The Executive Branch	Revisit Departments of the Executive Branch — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
3	GC.18	3	C	RC-GOV4: The Executive Branch	Revisit The Electoral College — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Form B — key & reteach

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
1	GC.16	1	B	RC-GOV4: The Executive Branch	Revisit Article II & the Presidency — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
2	GC.17	3	D	RC-GOV4: The Executive Branch	Revisit Departments of the Executive Branch — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
3	GC.18	2	A	RC-GOV4: The Executive Branch	Revisit The Electoral College — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Formative Checkpoints — key & reteach

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
1	GC.16	2	C	RC-GOV4: The Executive Branch	Revisit Article II & the Presidency — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
2	GC.17	1	B	RC-GOV4: The Executive Branch	Revisit Departments of the Executive Branch — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
3	GC.18	3	A	RC-GOV4: The Executive Branch	Revisit The Electoral College — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Part 5 — Psychometric Blueprint (Teacher)

ABOUT THESE NUMBERS

Every item carries a cognitive-rigor classification (Webb's DOK × Bloom's, located on the Hess Cognitive Rigor Matrix) and a pre-calibration IRT 3PL estimate: a = discrimination, b = difficulty, c = pseudo-guessing.

These IRT parameters are DESIGN-TIME ESTIMATES, not empirical calibrations. IRT 3PL parameters are pre-field-test design-time estimates, to be calibrated on field-test data. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Distractor codes: PK prior-knowledge · MC misconception · PE partial evidence · NE nearby error · CA causal attribution · AN anachronism · OG overgeneralization.

BANK DISTRIBUTION

DOK: 1: 2 · 2: 4 · 3: 3

Bloom's: Understand: 3 · Remember: 2 · Analyze: 2 · Apply: 1 · Evaluate: 1

Mean discrimination a ≈ 1.433 · Mean difficulty b ≈ 0.022

Field-test-ready items: 9 of 9

Form A — item psychometrics

Item	Std	DOK	Bloom's (Hess cell)	a	b	c	C3	FT?	Distractor codes
1	GC.16	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.4	0	0.2	D2	Y	A:PK B:MC C:PK
2	GC.17	2	Apply × DOK 2	1.4	0.1	0.2	D2	Y	B:NE C:NE D:PK
3	GC.18	3	Evaluate × DOK 3	1.7	0.7	0.2	D3	Y	A:MC B:MC D:NE

Form B — item psychometrics

Item	Std	DOK	Bloom's (Hess cell)	a	b	c	C3	FT?	Distractor codes
1	GC.16	1	Remember × DOK 1	1.1	-1	0.2	D2	Y	A:NE C:MC D:AN
2	GC.17	3	Analyze × DOK 3	1.7	0.7	0.2	D2	Y	A:PK B:PK C:PK
3	GC.18	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.4	0.1	0.2	D2	Y	B:MC C:MC D:MC

Formative — item psychometrics

Item	Std	DOK	Bloom's (Hess cell)	a	b	c	C3	FT?	Distractor codes
1	GC.16	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.4	0	0.2	D2	Y	A:MC B:PK D:PK
2	GC.17	1	Remember × DOK 1	1.1	-1	0.2	D2	Y	A:PK C:PK D:PK
3	GC.18	3	Analyze × DOK 3	1.7	0.6	0.2	D2	Y	B:MC C:MC D:MC

Part 6 — UDL Supports & Remediation (Teacher)

UNIVERSAL DESIGN FOR LEARNING (UDL 3.0) SUPPORTS — APPLIES TO EVERY ITEM

These supports vary the MEANS of access, not the mastery target. They apply to every item on the formative checkpoints and both summative forms.

Representation — CAST 3.0 Rep — key terms glossed (EN/ES); read-aloud on request; large-print/screen-reader friendly

Action & Expression — [MC] respond by selecting/pointing/AT · [open] respond in writing, speech, or a labeled diagram; word processor/speech-to-text available

Engagement — action-oriented feedback via the remediation routing; DOK-tiered challenge

Supports vary the means, not the mastery target — UDL design, not modification. CAST (2024). Universal Design for Learning Guidelines version 3.0.

HOW TO USE THIS SECTION

For each item: if a student misses it, start with the If-missed reteach, then route by the SPECIFIC wrong choice the student picked (each distractor signals a distinct misconception), and escalate through MTSS Tier 2 → Tier 3 if the misconception persists across parallel forms. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Form A — UDL & distractor-based remediation

Item 1 — GC.16 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Article II & the Presidency” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Prior-knowledge error — Congress declares war.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
B	Misconception — the Senate confirms appointments, not the President.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
C	Prior-knowledge error — Congress writes and passes statutes.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 2 — GC.17 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Departments of the Executive Branch” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
B	Nearby error — State handles the treaty, not law enforcement.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
C	Nearby error — Treasury handles the counterfeit money, not general law enforcement.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
D	Prior-knowledge error — Education sets school policy, not law enforcement.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 3 — GC.18 · DOK 3

If missed: Revisit “The Electoral College” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Misconception — the popular-vote winner does not always win the Electoral College.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
B	Misconception — states are central to the Electoral College.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
D	Nearby error — the House decides only if no candidate wins a majority, not every election.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Form B — UDL & distractor-based remediation**Item 1 — GC.16 · DOK 1**

If missed: Revisit “Article II & the Presidency” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Nearby error — the limit is two elected terms, not one.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
C	Misconception about the number of terms allowed.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
D	Anachronism — unlimited terms describe the era before the 22nd Amendment.	place events on a timeline

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
MTSS ROUTING Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item. Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.		

Item 2 — GC.17 · DOK 3

If missed: Revisit “Departments of the Executive Branch” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Prior-knowledge error — these are not the iron-triangle players.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
B	Prior-knowledge error — this describes the lawmaking branches, not the iron triangle.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
C	Prior-knowledge error — these shape opinion but are not the iron triangle.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item. Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.		
---	--	--

Item 3 — GC.18 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “The Electoral College” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
B	Misconception — land area does not set electoral votes.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
C	Misconception — electors are not equal for every state (that is the Senate rule).	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
D	Misconception — counties do not determine electors.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example

MTSS ROUTING Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item. Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.		
---	--	--

Formative Checkpoints — UDL & distractor-based remediation

Item 1 — GC.16 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Article II & the Presidency” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Misconception — the power is not limited to wartime.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
B	Prior-knowledge error — the Senate, not the Court, provides advice and consent.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
D	Prior-knowledge error — the House has no confirmation role over appointments.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10-15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 2 — GC.17 · DOK 1

If missed: Revisit “Departments of the Executive Branch” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Prior-knowledge error — Treasury handles money and taxes.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
C	Prior-knowledge error — Defense runs the armed forces.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
D	Prior-knowledge error — Justice enforces federal law.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10-15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 3 — GC.18 · DOK 3

If missed: Revisit “The Electoral College” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
B	Misconception — the Court does not choose the President.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
C	Misconception — the popular vote decides each state's electors.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
D	Misconception — the Cabinet plays no role in electing the President.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.